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Blog in!



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Blogs offer a little private space in the public domain of the Internet. Are blogs just another fad or will they be the biggest offering since Napster?

The Internet has become a dominant means of communication across the globe. It has enabled highly successful services such as e-mail and chat for direct conversation, and newsgroups and forums for publishing ideas and thoughts. People share not only opinions over the Internet, but also photographs, video, music and money. The Internet has evolved into a huge graffiti board where anyone can stick up their creations, for feedback and comments from people from all walks of life.

The Internet has also produced its share of fads and failures. One phenomenon that ranks high on the hype meter is Web logs, or blogs. Being free and without the burden of requiring additional infrastructure, they may just become as popular as forums, attracting large, like-minded communities.

Scientifically speaking...

Essentially, at the heart of it, blogging is just a personal online diary that you can share with your friends and family. They are quite like the online photo albums you can create at various Web sites, only blogs

are meant to hold more text content than images.

Blogs are quite similar to Web forums. On a forum, the creator sets the mood and topic for the discussions, and people post their views and ideas for others to see. The forum may be moderated to allow only certain content to be made public, to maintain the quality of the forum. A moderator can also ban malicious users from a forum. Think of a blog as your own personal forum, where you are the creator and moderator. The topic of discussion is you and your activities. You can invite several people to view and comment on your posts. If you wish, you can control what they post. When you sign up with a blogging site, it creates a personal space for you that is completely under your control.

Over time, people tend to discuss specific threads on their blogs and lots of blogs have evolved into valuable discussion chains of topics as diverse as technology, sports, art and even kung fu. People concentrate more on the quality of the content than on writing styles and punctuation—in fact, blogs enable a lot of ingenious essays to be published, which

otherwise may not get published under publishers of traditional media like

Personally speaking...

Blogs provide the ideal medium for jotting down all the interesting things you do, the little things you learnt, the little things you do, the pranks you play, anything you want. It's an easy way for others to keep up with you, so the time you meet a friend, your conversation can go a bit further than, "...so you been up with you?"

The most important attribute of blogs is that they are personal. In a vast public medium such as the Internet, the concept of personal space can be very compelling. Not only is it quite addictive for those who maintain these diaries, it has a similar effect on visitors too. Also, people's blogs by nature are attached with a credibility—a person tends to write the bare truth, so a first-person view of the Twin Towers on a blog holds more value than a similar write-up in a local newspaper. Readers know behind the blogs are people who a